

APURBA DEBNATH

✉ apurba.debnath@ucsf.edu

🌐 linkedin.com/in/apurba-debnath

🐙 apurba.github

🐙 apurba.github.io

EDUCATION

University of California, San Francisco

Master of Science in Biomedical Imaging | GPA: 3.9/4.0

Thesis: *Spectral Graph modeling of abnormal neural synchronizations in Alzheimer's disease.*

San Francisco, CA

SEP 2025 – SEP 2026

National Institute of Technology Durgapur

Bachelor of Technology in Biotechnology | Major GPA: 3.78/4.00, CS GPA: 4.0/4.0.

Thesis: *Machine learning-based approach for the design and release kinetics prediction of the PLGA-based drug delivery systems.*

Durgapur, India

DEC 2020 – MAY 2024

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of California, San Francisco, San Francisco, CA, USA

Graduate Student Researcher, Brain Networks Laboratory, UCSF

Co-Advisors: Prof. Ashish Raj & Prof. Srikanth Nagarajan

JAN 2026 – Present

- Analyzed the MEG recordings from cohorts of 77 healthy controls (HC) and Alzheimer's disease (AD) patients, where AD was accompanied by significant increase in δ - θ (1–7 Hz) power and reduction in α - β - γ (8–51 Hz) power, consistent with the previous studies.
- Developed a graph-theoretic biophysical neural mass model to deconvolve scale-free neural driving signals and model oscillatory brain activity in HC and AD cohorts, and achieved > 0.90 Pearson correlation and < 0.5 RMSE between modeled and empirical MEG spectra across 246 cortical/subcortical regions while successfully recovering latent scale-free neural driving signals..
- Quantified deconvolved neural driving signals and demonstrated that AD pathology ($A\beta$ and tau accumulation) is accompanied by significant alterations in scale-free neural dynamics, with spatial alterations in the delta–theta, alpha, and beta bands recapitulating regions selectively vulnerable to AD pathology.
- Demonstrated that altered scale-free neural driving signals disrupt excitation–inhibition (E/I) dynamics, with AD exhibiting significantly increased excitatory time constants, and with the severity of cognitive decline the inter-regional connectivity dysfunction became much more apparent, reflected in prolonged temporal dynamics of long-range excitatory neuronal projections.

Indian Institute of Technology Madras, Chennai, India

Post-Baccalaureate Researcher, Centre for Integrative Biology and Systems Medicine (IBSE)

Co-Advisors: Dr. Parul Verma (IIT Madras) & Dr. Marie-Constance Corsi (Paris Brain Institute)

JUL 2024 – JUL 2025

- Analyzed EEG/MEG recordings from a longitudinal cohort of 19 healthy participants across four motor imagery (MI)-based BCI training sessions, along with an independent EEG dataset of 16 participants trained on a separate BCI paradigm.
- Developed a biophysically informed neural mass model to investigate the neural mechanisms underlying MI-BCI learning, achieving Pearson correlation of > 0.90 and RMSE of < 0.3 between modeled and empirical M/EEG power spectra for most brain regions, subjects, and sessions in both MI and resting-state (RS) conditions.
- Demonstrated that the regional activation accompanied by significantly reduced excitatory time constant during MI compared to RS, and revealed that BCI training drives a shift from diffuse to targeted sensorimotor recruitment/activation. Additionally, identified that the excitatory time constant strongly associated with event-related desynchronization/synchronization (ERD/ERS), providing a mechanistic interpretation of BCI learning dynamics and biologically informed individualized BCI training protocols.

National Institute of Technology Durgapur, India

Undergraduate Researcher, Department of Biotechnology

Advisor: Prof. Dalia Dasgupta Mandal

AUG 2023 – MAY 2024

- Developed and benchmarked 8 ML regression models to predict drug release kinetics in PLGA-based drug delivery systems using a dataset of 1,914 experimental drug release profiles across 20 drug–polymer formulations having cancerous and non-cancerous drugs.
- Designed an end-to-end predictive modeling pipeline, where Random Forest and XGBoost exhibited strong predictive performance for initial/early-stage ($\approx 50\%$) drug release kinetics.
- Optimized Random Forest model achieved a test R^2 of 0.71, MSE of 0.0264, and MAE of 0.1169, while reducing the feature space from 17 to 7 key physicochemical features and identified molecular weight, drug loading capacity, surface area-to-volume ratio, and time as key determinants of drug release kinetics.

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Debnath, A.**, Venot, T., Corsi, M-C. & Verma, P., “*Neural mechanisms of training in Brain-Computer Interface: A Biophysical modeling approach*,”(under review) (<https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.06.21.660834>)
2. Debnath, A.*, Barron, N.*, Prabhu, P., Ranasinghe, K., Nagarajan, S., & Raj, A., “*Altered frequency-dependent neural driving signals significantly impair E/I dynamics in Alzheimer's disease.*” (in prep.)

SELECTED CONFERENCE POSTERS

1. Debnath, A., Barron, N., Raj, A. (2026). **Spectral Graph modeling of abnormal neural synchronizations in Alzheimer's disease.** *2026 UCSF Annual Radiology Research Conference, Santa Cruz, CA. Poster: March 30, 2026.*
2. Debnath, A., Verma, P., Corsi, M-C. (2025). **A biophysical model to infer neural mechanisms of motor imagery in brain-computer interface training.** *OHBM 2025 Annual Meeting, Brisbane, Australia. Poster: June 27-28, 2025.*
3. Debnath, A., Corsi, M-C., Verma, P. (2025). **A Neural mass modeling approach for uncovering neural mechanisms in motor imagery-based brain-computer interface.** *Wadhvani School of Data Science and Artificial Intelligence (WSAI) Annual Research Showcase 2025, IIT Madras, India. Poster: May 17, 2025.*
4. Debnath, A., Corsi, M-C., Verma, P. (2025). **Biophysical modeling to elucidate the underlying neural mechanisms in EEG-based brain-computer interface.** *Physics of Cells & Tissues (PoCT) 3.0 Symposium, Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru, India. Poster: February 21, 2025.*

SELECTED PROJECTS

Decoding Cognitive tasks from functional-MRI using machine learning

UCSF | 2026

- Designed ML pipelines to preprocess/process voxel-level task-based fMRI data of two sessions from 10 healthy subjects using fMRIPrep.
- Trained a Support Vector Machine (SVM) classifier on these voxel-level preprocessed BOLD signals to decode and classify different language and motor tasks across 10 healthy subjects. Trained SVM achieved an overall accuracy of 86.1% across tasks and subjects, with a strong performance in decoding language tasks, achieving an F1-score of 0.95, and moderate performance in classifying motor tasks, with an F1-score of 0.77. Notably, 21% of motor task instances were misclassified as language tasks.

Deep learning models for brain MRI denoising: A comparative benchmark study

UCSF | 2026

- Designed and implemented deep learning pipelines to train and benchmark denoising autoencoders (CAE, VAE, ResNet, and UNet) using 7000 T1 MRI slices from 128 subjects, under both fixed and variable noise conditions.
- ResNet and UNet consistently achieved strong performance, with SSIM values reaching ~ 0.92 – 0.96 , PSNR ~ 30 – 34 dB, and EPI ~ 0.85 – 0.92 across noise levels. In contrast, CAE demonstrated moderate performance (SSIM ~ 0.85 – 0.91 , PSNR ~ 27 – 31 dB, EPI ~ 0.78 – 0.88), while VAE showed the lowest scores (SSIM ~ 0.75 – 0.88 , PSNR ~ 25 – 29 dB, EPI ~ 0.70 – 0.82) with higher variability.

AWARDS AND HONORS

- | | |
|---|-------------|
| • MS Thesis Research Grant (\$8000 in total) | Summer 2026 |
| • IBSE Post-Baccalaureate Fellowship (\$6000 in total) | 2024–2025 |
| • Paris Brain Institute Travel Award for OHBM 2025 Annual Meeting at Brisbane | 2025 |
| • IBSE Travel Award for Physics of Cells & Tissues 3.0 Symposium at IISc | 2025 |
| • NEC Merit Scholarship to pursue Bachelor's degree (\$1140 in total) | 2020–2024 |

SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, MATLAB, C/C++, SQL, $\text{\LaTeX}$
- **Frameworks/Softwares:** NumPy, Pandas, SciPy, Matplotlib, Scikit-Learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Nilearn, fMRIPrep
- **Neuroimaging/Reserch:** EEG, MEG, f-MRI, d-MRI; Neuroscience, BCI, Drug Delivery Systems.
- **Others:** Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Git/Github, Linux, CoreHPC

RELEVANT COURSES TAKEN

Graduate Courses:

- **Biomedical Imaging/Bioengineering & Neuroscience:** Principles of MRI – MRI Physics, Systems and Behavioural Neuroscience, Advanced Neurological Imaging, Machine Learning Algorithms for Medical Imaging, Image Processing and Analysis-I & II, Physical Principles of CT, PET and SPECT Imaging, Ultrasound, Imaging Probes for Nuclear and Optical Imaging, Imaging Study Design.

UG Courses:

- **Biotechnology:** Cell Biology and Genetics, Molecular Biology and rDNA Technology, Biochemistry and Enzyme Technology, Human Genomics, Bioinformatics, Cancer Biology and Cell Signaling.
- **Mathematics:** Linear Algebra, Calculus, Ordinary Differential Equations, Probability, Partial Differential Equations.
- **Computer Science:** Introduction to Computing, Programming and Data Structures, Compiler Design, Database Management Systems.
- **Others:** Electrical Eng.– Control Systems.